Paul Warner

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Summary

IT and engineering leader with 25 years across software engineering, platform engineering, cloud operations and, most recently, enterprise AI. Started as a hands-on software engineer building fiber access systems, grew into engineering management, then moved into IT to build Ciena's cloud governance and operations function as a Director. Most recently led IT for Ciena's global Sales organization, including enterprise AI adoption and governance.

Servant leader, passionate about enabling others with technology, who enjoys building and leading teams, working with partners and going deep on new technologies.

Experience

Director IT

Ciena · Buffalo, NY (remote) · May 2022 – Oct 2026

- IT Lead for Sales
- Lead IT partner to Ciena's global Sales organization (~1,000 users in four regions) for Salesforce, quoting, sales enablement and AI platforms.
- Partnered with Sales leaders to make Sales the top user of Microsoft 365 Copilot at Ciena and the first paying customer for Copilot Cowork, with cost governance built in from the start.
- Ran Ciena's Claude Code trial, comparing it side by side with GitHub Copilot, and enabled product security teams on Claude.
- Drove the IT side of a global partner pricing program that cut quote creation time from a week to minutes.

Director, IT Cloud Services

Ciena · Petaluma, CA and remote · Sep 2020 – May 2022

- Led a team of 12 covering cloud governance and operations across AWS and Azure.
- Moved cloud teams to Infrastructure as Code with Terraform, Ansible and PowerShell, and pushed fault-tolerant, multi-AZ deployments.

Director, IT Cloud Infrastructure & Collaboration

Ciena · Petaluma, CA · Dec 2017 – Sep 2020

- Built and ran IT cloud infrastructure and collaboration applications for 8,000 employees.
- Established Datadog as Ciena's cloud-first monitoring platform and ran on-call operations for cloud and Microsoft 365 services.

Senior Manager, Infrastructure Software / DevOps

Ciena Blue Planet · Petaluma, CA · Aug 2015 – Dec 2017

- Led the team that built the shared platform every Blue Planet product shipped on: databases, messaging, access control, logging and metrics.

Software Engineer to Engineering Manager

Cyan, Inc. (acquired by Ciena) · Petaluma, CA · Sep 2007 – Aug 2015

- Grew from engineer to manager across network management, the Blue Planet SDN platform and DevOps, staying hands-on with Python, Django REST and Docker.

Software Engineer

Tellabs (formerly AFC) · Petaluma, CA · Jun 2001 – Sep 2007

- Led a small team delivering a fiber-to-the-premise system that went on to serve over one million customers.

Projects

- job-application-kit: a template for keeping a resume in Markdown, tailoring it per job with Claude Code, and building Word and PDF versions with GitHub Actions. This page is built with it.

Education and certifications

- Bachelor's, Computer Engineering, Clarkson University, 2001
- Certified Scrum Product Owner (CSPO), Scrum Alliance, 2019

Written in Markdown, tailored with Claude Code and built automatically with GitHub Actions: github.com/warnerpr/job-application-kit